



(Don't Write
anything in this Area)

Religion and Culture Ecology

Durkheim in 'Elementary forms of Religious life' defines religion as a unified system of beliefs and practices related to sacred things, which create a moral community called church, all those who adhere to it.

Culture Ecology is a theory proposed by Julian Steward which studies the influence of local ecology on culture.

Religion and Culture Ecology

The ecological environment in which a community lives can significantly shape up the religious beliefs of people.

An example is the case of animistic belief found in many tribes. Prof KP Vidyarthi in study of

For

'Males' showed how the Males who live in forest ecology have belief in spirits called Cosgyim. The spirit ties with social cultural life of the tribes and together they form a Nature - Man - Spirit complex.

Marvin Harris too shows that ecological conditions in ancient India, i.e. the growth of agricultural economy, led to the birth of Sacred Cow Myth as cow provided draft animals and milk and thus maximised mode of production and reproduction.

Thus religious belief is deeply intertwined with ecological conditions.